
PRE-LAW ADVISING HANDBOOK

YESHIVA UNIVERSITY
Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development
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WELCOME

Welcome to Pre-Law Career Advising at Yeshiva University! We are delighted to welcome you and are excited to support you as you embark on your journey toward a legal career.

It's important to emphasize that it's never too early to begin this process. The Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development pre-law career advisement offers personalized guidance to current students and alumni, starting from the moment you begin considering a law career until you transition to law school. We strongly encourage you to arrange one-on-one meetings with our pre-law career advisor at least once per semester. During these sessions, you can create a roadmap for your application timeline, explore various internship opportunities, and work on crafting persuasive personal statements and completing law school applications as you progress in your academic journey.

Active engagement within both your campus and local community is also highly valuable. Law schools appreciate applicants who demonstrate involvement in their undergraduate institutions and communities. As part of the Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development, the Pre-Law office offers valuable information about internships, volunteer opportunities, and Pre-Law events. To ensure you stay informed about these opportunities, we recommend joining our pre-law listserv. To sign up, please get in touch with Illana Julius at illana.julius@yu.edu.

We eagerly look forward to collaborating with you throughout your undergraduate experience. We are here to address any questions or concerns you may have about the application process or your decision to pursue legal education.

We're excited to meet you in person!

Best Wishes,

Illana Julius

Pre-law Career Advisor

Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development

YOUR PRE-LAW ADVISING TEAM

The Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development

The SGC offers support in crafting resumes securing internships and provides guidance on all aspects of graduate school, including help preparing your law school personal statement.

Wilf Campus
Furst Hall, Suite 530
646-592-4090
Email: careercenter@yu.edu
Web: www.yu.edu/sgc

Beren Campus
215 Lex, 5th Floor
646-592-4135
Email: careercenter@yu.edu
Web: www.yu.edu/sgc

Office of Academic Support

The Office of Academic Support is available to work with students on improving study skills such as time management, critical reading, note-taking, and test-taking. Please email for an appointment.

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The Office of Disability Services

The Office of Disability Services works in partnership with students, faculty, and staff to ensure appropriate accommodations and support for students who identify as having a disability. If you would like to have a conversation about your specific situation and your needs related to your disability, please don't hesitate to reach out to the Office of Disability Services in person, via email, or by phone using the contact information provided below:

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PRE-LAW EDUCATION

Law schools do not have a preference for or requirement regarding specific undergraduate majors. Yeshiva University aligns with the American Bar Association's perspective that there is no "best" major or prescribed set of courses for law school preparation. Instead, we recommend pursuing a curriculum that includes challenging and well-rounded courses emphasizing the development of crucial skills like critical reading, writing, and analytical thinking.

Your undergraduate experience should be a time to explore the diverse academic offerings at the university, refine your skills, and showcase your expertise in a particular academic field. While some students opt for traditional Pre-Law majors such as English, political science, history, and economics, it's worth noting that successful law school applicants have majored in a wide range of subjects, including music, biology, mathematics, computer science, and business.

Admissions committees value applicants who have undertaken academically challenging majors and pursued a comprehensive course of study. For those who choose majors with a significant technical or quantitative focus (e.g., hard sciences, computer science, or mathematics), it's advisable to complement their studies with humanities courses that emphasize writing skills. This balanced approach demonstrates your ability to engage critically with texts and effectively communicate, which are essential skills for success in law school and the legal profession.

Knowledge Areas

The American Bar Association has identified seven areas of knowledge that serve as the best foundation for legal studies:

- ✓ History, particularly American, and an understanding of the political, cultural, and economic factors that led to the development of our society in the United States
- ✓ Political thought and theory, and the American political system
- ✓ Ethical theory and theories of justice
- ✓ Economics, especially microeconomic theory
- ✓ Basic mathematical and financial skills, including pre-calculus mathematics and the ability to analyze financial data
- ✓ An understanding of human behavior and social interaction
- ✓ An appreciation of the diversity of cultures within and beyond the United States, international institutions, and increasing global interdependence

Specific Skills

The core skills necessary to succeed in law school are:

- ✓ analytic/problem-solving skills
- ✓ critical reading
- ✓ writing
- ✓ oral communication
- ✓ listening abilities
- ✓ research skills
- ✓ time management and organization



These skills will provide a solid foundation for a legal education. Law school will further refine these skills, but students should enter with reasonably well-developed abilities in these areas.

Students should take several courses that require extensive reading, research, writing, and oral presentations, especially advanced level and honors seminars, english composition, literature, and public speaking courses. The importance of oral and written communication skills cannot be overstated. Additionally, mathematics, computer science (COM 1300), economics (ECO 1031, ECO 1041), logic (PHI 1100), and the natural sciences will aid in the development of analytical and quantitative skills. Finally, students considering international law or law in a bilingual community should take advantage of opportunities to learn languages and study abroad through one of Yeshiva University's programs.

Some students find it challenging to determine whether law will be a suitable career choice. They may want to explore the law school option by enrolling in one or two law-oriented courses to gauge their interest in this area. Some suggestions are below:

BUSINESS: 1001H Business in a Global Environment; Business and Jewish Law BLW 2500

COMPUTER SCIENCE: COM 1001 Programming for Non-CS Majors; COM 1300 Intro to Computer Programming

ECONOMICS: 1031 Intro to Economics (Micro); 1041 Intro to Economics II (Macro); 1101 Intermediate Microeconomics, 1701 International Economics

ENGLISH: 2010 Interpreting Texts; 1450 Writing with Power

HISTORY: 2607 International Crimes; 1202 Survey of U.S. History II; 2210 US: 1941- Present; 2220 American Presidents; 2601 History of the Law

JHI: 3510 Writing Jewish History

PHILOSOPHY: 1101 Logic, 1600 Ethics, 2500H Law: Jewish and Western Perspectives

POLITICS: 1501 Fundamentals of Political Science; 2315 Int'l Law and Organization; 2135 Voting and Elections; 1101 Intro to American Politics; 2105 Congress and Legislature Process; 2291 Democracy and its Critics

PSYCHOLOGY: 3840 Psychology and the Law

SOCIOLOGY: 1413H Social Inequality

Students should be aware that most law schools actively discourage pre-law students from taking too many law-related courses, as they prefer that students concentrate on acquiring a broad field of general knowledge and skills as a sound foundation for legal studies.

PRE-LAW SUGGESTED READING LIST

For a complete list of up-to-date articles of interest to pre-law students, please visit the website at <https://www.yu.edu/academic-advising/pre-law>.

- 24 Hours with 24 Lawyers: Profiles of Traditional and Non-Traditional Careers (Jasper Kim)
- 55 Successful Harvard Law School Application Essays: What Worked for Them Can Help You Get Into the Law School of Your Choice (Staff of the Harvard Crimson)
- A Civil Action (Jonathan Harr)
- A Matter of Interpretation (Antonin Scalia)
- Affective Assistance of Counsel, Marjorie Silver
- All The Laws But One, William Rehnquist
- An Introduction to Law & Economics (Mitchell Polinsky)
- An Introduction to Legal Reasoning (Edward Levi)
- An Introduction to the Philosophy of Law (Roscoe Pound)
- Cardozo: A Study In Reputation, Richard A. Posner
- Damages, Barry Werth
- First: Sandra Day O'Connor, Evan Thomas
- Getting To Maybe: How to Excel on Law School Exams (Richard Michael Fischl and Jeremy Paul)
- Gideon's Trumpet (Anthony Lewis)
- Gideon's Trumpet, Anthony Lewis
- How To Get Into Law School (5th Edition)
- How To Get Into The Top Law Schools (3rd Edition), Richard Montauk JD
- How To Succeed In Law School (3rd Edition)
- Jane Sherron de Hart
- John Marshall: Definer Of A Nation, Jean Edward Smith
- Law 101 (Jay M. Feinman)
- Law And Social Norms, Eric A. Posner
- Law School 101, R. Stephanie Good
- Law School Confidential (Robert H. Miller)
- Law School Confidential, Robert H. Miller
- Law vs. Life (Walt Bachman)
- Law's Empire (Ronald Dworkin)
- Lawyer: A Life Of Counsel And Controversy, Arthur L. Limen
- Letters From Law School: The Life of a Second-Year Law Student (Lawrence Dieker)
- Letters to a Young Lawyer, Alan M. Dershowitz, Esq.
- Oliver Wendell Holmes, Jr., G. Edward White
- One L (Scott Turow)
- Planet Law School II, Atticus Falcon, Esq.
- Punishment and Responsibility (H.L.A. Hart)
- Ruth Bader Ginsburg: A Life,



- Safe Haven in America: Battles to Open the Golden Door, Michael Wildes, Esq.
- Should You Really Be a Lawyer (Deobrah Schneider)
- Should You Really Be A Lawyer—A Guide To Smart Career Choices Before, During And After Law School, Deborah Schneider and Gary Belsky
- Simple Rules for a Complicated World (Richard Epstein)
- So You Want To Be A Lawyer, Law School Admission Council
- Starting Off Right In Law School, Carolyn Nygren and Susan Estrich
- The Best Law Schools' Admissions Secrets: The Essential Guide from Harvard's Former Admissions Dean (Joyce Curll)
- The Bramble Bush: Our Law and Its Study (Karl Llewellyn)
- The Federalist Papers
- The Fraternity: Lawyers And Judges In Collusion, John F. Molloy
- The Ivey Guide To Law School Admissions, Anna Ivey
- The Ivey Guide to Law School Admissions: Straight Advice on Essays, Resumes, Interviews, and More (Anna Ivey)
- The Law School Labyrinth: A Guide to Making the Most of Your Legal Education (Steven Sedberry)
- The Lawyer Myth: A Defense of the American Legal Profession (Rennard Strickland and Frank T. Read)
- The Lost Lawyer, Anthony T. Kronman
- The Love (Lure) Of The Law: Why People Become Lawyers And What The Profession Does To Them, Richard Moll
- The Lure of the Law: Why People Become Lawyers, and What the Profession Does to Them (Richard Moll)
- The Majesty Of The Law, Sandra Day O'connor
- The Most Democratic Branch: How The Courts Serve America, Jeffrey Rosen
- The Nature of the Judicial Process (Benjamin Nathan Cardozo)
- The Nine: Inside the Secret World of the Supreme Court (Jeffrey Toobin)
- The Official Guide to Legal Specialties: An Insider's Guide to Every Major Practice Area (Lisa Abrams)
- The Origin Of Adversary Criminal Trial, John H. Langbein
- The Path of Law (Oliver Wendell Holmes)
- The Politics Of Law: A Progressive Critique, David Kairys (Editor)
- The Rule Of Lawyers: How The New Litigation Elite Threatens America's Rule Of Law, Walter K. Olson
- The Supreme Court, William Rehnquist
- The Tempting of America (Robert Bork)
- The United States Supreme Court: The Pursuit Of Justice, Christopher Tomlins (Editor)
- The Words We Live By: Your Annotated Guide To The Constitution, Linda R. Monk
- To Be a Trial Lawyer (F. Lee Bailey)
- Tomorrow's Lawyers: An Introduction to Your Future (Richard Susskin)



THE APPLICATION PROCESS—FAQ'S

What factors are most important for admission to law school?

GPA and LSAT

Two primary factors for admission to law school are your grade point average (GPA) and your Law School Admissions Test (LSAT) score. Law schools vary in the weight they accord to each, but some schools give the LSAT significantly more weight. Thus, it is important both to keep your grades up and to prepare thoroughly for the LSAT. Most schools will take account of trends in your undergraduate performance; if you had a bad first year and then improved your grades, it will be noted.

What else will the admissions committee consider?

Personal statement. Your personal statement gives you the chance to set yourself apart from other applicants. What are your accomplishments? What unique experiences have you had? What difficulties have you overcome? Use the personal statement to show the Admissions Committee what is special about you. Make certain that you show the personal statement to your pre-law career advisor.

Letters of recommendation. Many law schools require two or more letters of recommendation. These letters should be from professors or employers who know you well enough to comment on your abilities, work habits, and character. Vague letters from people who do not know you well are not helpful.

Work experience. Law schools are interested in work experience that shows motivation and a capacity to succeed in a nonacademic environment. Especially if you are waiting several years after graduation to apply to law school, as many students do, this work experience will be considered.

Personal and academic integrity. Law school applications require you to report any violations of Yeshiva University's social and academic integrity codes as well as any criminal convictions. Some schools will require a Dean's certification in which the Dean indicates whether the student has any violations on his record.

What is the Law School Admissions Council ("LSAC")?

The Law School Admissions Council streamlines the process for applying to law school. The LSAC website is located at lsac.org. Students can use this site to:

- ✓ Register for the LSAT
- ✓ Purchase study materials
- ✓ Sign up for Credentials Assembly Service (CAS)
- ✓ Research schools
- ✓ Complete online applications
- ✓ Utilize the letters of recommendation and evaluation service

What is the Credential Assembly Service (“CAS”)?

The CAS compiles and summarizes information about each applicant. This summary is called a law school report and is sent to each school the applicant applies to. The law school report includes the applicant’s LSAT scores, writing samples, undergraduate and graduate grades, as well as some biographical information. CAS also offers a letter of recommendation and evaluation service. Most American Bar Association (“ABA”) approved law schools require applicants to subscribe to CAS.

Applicants can sign up for CAS on the LSAC website located at lsac.org. There is a one-time fee of \$200. The CAS account is active for 5 years from the date it is set up. Fee waivers may be granted in cases of extreme need.

In order for CAS to compile a law school report, applicants must:

- ✓ Create an LSAC Account
- ✓ Make sure they have a reportable LSAT Score
- ✓ Provide information about the schools they have attended to LSAC
- ✓ Print and sign a transcript request form and formally request a transcript from the registrar of each and every post-secondary university they have attended. The transcript will then be sent directly to LSAC.

Applicants can sign up for CAS at the same time they register for the LSAT but are not required to do both simultaneously. However, applicants should pay the CAS fee and complete the above steps at least 4-6 weeks before their first law school application deadline.



LAW SCHOOL APPLICATION TIMELINE

Pre-law Application Timeline

Year 1

- Focus on your grades and commit to your coursework.
- Take a variety of courses that require you to read, write, research, and analyze but make sure you check in with your academic advisor to ensure you are on track for both your major and gen ed requirements.
- Meet with your pre-law career advisor.
- Sign up for the Pre-law list serve.
- Explore major options. Consider your interests.
- Join a student organization of interests (i.e., Pre-Law Student Association, Mock Trial, Moot Court, Student Association)

Year 2

- Declare your major by the end of your sophomore or the beginning of your junior year.
- Get your resume reviewed by the Shevet Glaubach Center and keep it updated.
- Take a practice LSAT exam; test companies that offer free exams.
- Conduct informational interviews or job shadowing with current attorneys (on-campus, in your hometown, using LinkedIn or YUMVP to source for contacts)
- Meet with your pre-law career advisor and outline goals for the application.
- Begin identifying professors who might serve as your recommenders and speak with them about your plans.
- Create a “Future JD Student” Account on LSAC.org.
- Attend a “Law School Application Workshop” hosted by pre-law career advising and meet with your pre-law career advisor.
- Register and prepare for the LSAT; consider taking a Prep Course (summer)
- Register for the LSAC’s Credential Assembly Service
- Consider a law-related internship for the spring or summer.
- Start or expand your target school list by researching at least 12.
- Consider a Judicial Internship; you must have a 3.5 GPA or higher.

Year 3

- Start or expand your target school list by researching at least 10.
- Consider a Judicial Internship; you must have a 3.5 GPA or higher.
- Begin drafting your personal statement and meet with your pre-law career advisor and the writing center.
- Finalize your target school list and research all optional essays and document requirements.
- Request and secure letters of recommendation by September 1.
- Complete your file with the Credential Assembly Service.
- Request transcripts from Registrar.
- Ensure all letters of recommendation are uploaded.
- Finish your statement and have it reviewed by the Writing Center and your pre-law career advisor.
- Write all supplemental/optional essays.
- Plan visits to schools on your list.
- Research financial aid; complete FAFSA in October.
- Submit your applications by Thanksgiving if you can.



THE LSAT

Preparing for the Law School Admissions Test

The LSAT is a challenging test that assesses fundamental intellectual skills rather than specific knowledge areas. Some students benefit from LSAT prep courses, while others self-prepare using LSAT prep books from LSAC.org. Regardless of your approach, practice is key, and it's crucial to simulate test conditions for optimal preparation. Taking the LSAT as a practice run is discouraged and could harm your admission prospects.

The LSAT is available in January, April, June, July, October, and November. Ideally, consider taking the exam in June before planning to enter law school, typically at the end of your junior year. This allows for the option to retake it in October while still meeting early to mid-November application deadlines. The June exam is advantageous as it's not held on Shabbat, providing itemized score reports for valuable insights into your performance. Other test dates on Shabbat have alternate arrangements for Sabbath observers, but they are non-disclosed, providing only basic score information. Some students prefer the October test for extra summer preparation time.

The test covers four areas. Suggestions for developing strengths in each area are listed below.

Reading Comprehension

This section tests one's ability to understand, analyze, and interpret a brief but dense piece of writing and to answer questions about its content and perspective. To prepare, one should take courses that involve extensive reading and critical analysis of complete texts. Advanced courses in literature, history, politics or philosophy provide this type of training.

Analytical Reasoning

Also called Logic Games, this section presents problems involving the grouping, ordering, and spatial relationships of objects. It tests the ability to think precisely and methodically and to solve problems with order and logic. Preparation can include courses in mathematics, natural sciences, and computer science and well as in philosophy (logic).

Logical Thinking

This section asks students questions about a short-written argument—its main points, assumptions, inferences, errors in argumentation, its applicability to a new context, and whether a new piece of evidence would support or weaken the argument. Courses that provide practice in analytical arguments and theories are offered by political scientists, philosophers, historians, and economists.

Writing

This section assesses your writing and argumentation skills. It is designed to assess a test-taker's ability to construct a persuasive argument and express ideas clearly and coherently. It typically consists of a single prompt that presents a specific issue or topic related to a legal or social context. Test-takers are required to take a position on the given topic and provide reasons and evidence to support their viewpoint. The writing section does not require any prior knowledge of the law or legal concepts, and there are no right or wrong answers; instead, it evaluates the ability to analyze, organize, and present arguments effectively.

LETTERS OF RECOMMENDATION/ EVALUATIONS

How many recommendation letters should I aim for?

Students should aim to get a total of 3-4 letters of recommendation and/or evaluations.

Whom should I ask for letters of recommendation and/ or evaluations?

Applicants may ask professors, supervisors, employers, community leaders, or other mentors for letters of recommendation. In general, unless the applicant has been out of school for an extended period, at least one letter preferably two, should be from a professor.

Can I read my recommendation letters?

Under the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, students applying to law schools in the United States have the right to review letters of recommendation which are written for them. However, students would be well-advised to waive this right because law schools have indicated that these letters are more candid and therefore more effective.

What is the difference between letters of recommendation and evaluations?

The evaluation service is a recent addition designed to help recommenders assess applicants more objectively and quantitatively. When a student adds an evaluator to their list, LSAC contacts the evaluator to electronically rate the applicant on various cognitive and non-cognitive skills deemed important for law school success. Evaluators also have the option to include comments about each applicant. Applicants have the flexibility to use both evaluations and recommendations or choose one over the other. However, it's essential to review individual school requirements, as some schools mandate either evaluations exclusively or recommendations exclusively.

Is there an advantage to using evaluations over letters of recommendation?

In general, no. It is a matter of personal preference on the part of the recommender/evaluator and on the part of the applicant. However, if a school prefers or requires evaluations, care must be taken to comply with this preference.

Are recommendations automatically sent to each school I apply to?

No, the CAS service will show applicants which letters have been received and processed. After this time, applicants must assign letters or evaluations to the schools they apply to.

PAY ATTENTION TO THE INSTRUCTIONS GIVEN BY EACH SCHOOL!

What materials should I give to my recommenders?

Students should schedule in-person meeting with each recommender and provide them with their transcript, resume, a paper they wrote for the class (if applicable) and their personal statement.

What are the qualities that should be highlighted in letters of recommendation?

- ✓ The letter should make it clear that the recommender knows you well;
- ✓ That they've known you long enough to write with authority;
- ✓ That they are confident that they know the caliber of your work;
- ✓ They have a high opinion of you;
- ✓ They know your educational and career goals;
- ✓ They should be able to favorably compare you with your peers;
- ✓ Letters should be on letterhead, signed, and dated



PERSONAL STATEMENT

How to write a winning personal statement for Law School

What Admissions Needs to See

The personal statement is your interview on paper. It is your chance to show the admissions committee who you are and why you want to attend law school. What makes you a winning candidate, and what attributes do you bring to the incoming class? It is your opportunity to go beyond your GPA and your LSAT score. Tell a good story, and make sure every sentence leads into the next. The writing must be excellent; this usually takes several drafts. Start with a powerful hook sentence and end with expressing gratitude for this academic opportunity. The tone of the paper should be positive. Write mostly about you, not your relative or another entity.

Begin Writing

Start with a lead sentence and begin to tell your story. Check spelling, grammar, and punctuation. Check for run-on sentences and make sure your essay flows. Eliminate useless filler words and re-read and re-write until you have your perfect essay. Is your writing clear? Can the reader understand what you are trying to share?

Length: double-spaced, 12 font, and no longer than 2 pages

Purpose:

- 1) Provide the committee a picture of who you are
- 2) Demonstrate your reason for wanting to pursue law school
- 3) Your chance to stand out beyond a number

An exercise that will help you write: Ask yourself the following questions: When was the first time I thought about law school, and why? What do I feel when I hear the words lawyer, or law firm, or justice? Have you personally experienced or witnessed an injustice? Did this change your life, and if so, how?

Key Components to Consider

- Who are you? What are your career plans/aspirations? When did your interest in law school develop? Where do you hope to have an impact? Have you demonstrated your interest in this field and what makes you a unique candidate?
- **(Demonstrate do not state, relate rather than pontificate)**
- Tell your story, do not rehash your resume; share what you have learned and what you hope to achieve from attending law school.
- Avoid cliches, various dramatic phrases, and quotations. Do not write anything negative about yourself, your profession, or anyone else.
- Talk about helping people and keep it positive. Be truthful, remember everything in your personal statement is subject to discussion should you have an interview.

Do

- ✓ Discuss your topic with the Pre-Law Career Advisor before you invest a lot of time in writing it
- ✓ Hook your reader in the first paragraph
- ✓ Revise, revise, revise
- ✓ Write sincerely
- ✓ Remember your audience



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- ✓ Make your personal statement unique to you
 - ✓ Incorporate specifics and details
 - ✓ Write clearly and grammatically
 - ✓ Make sure it flows

DON'T

- ✓ Exceed the page or word limit
- ✓ Write about writing your personal statement
- ✓ Focus on the negative
- ✓ Write the name of the wrong school
- ✓ Write about why you want to go to law school if you don't have a clear reason for doing so.
- ✓ Use clichés

Still not sure what to write about? Try a free-write on each of these prompts. Set a timer for 30 minutes and write whatever comes to mind without worrying about grammar or word usage.

Writing Support

Your Pre-Law Career Advisor, the Writing Center, and the Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development

Personal Statement Prompts

- ✓ What do you remember most from your childhood?
- ✓ What was the best/ worst piece of advice you've ever received? Did you follow it?
- ✓ Has someone influenced your life in a meaningful way? Describe your reaction to this person and how you changed. (Make sure you are writing about yourself and not your mentor)
- ✓ Describe a mistake you made and how you have matured because of it. (Be careful with this one. You want to make sure you are painting yourself in a positive light.)
- ✓ What would you do if you were not afraid of failure?
- ✓ Has an event in your life caused you to reevaluate an idea you've always thought to be true?
- ✓ What do you wish your childhood/young adulthood could have looked like?
- ✓ What difficult situations have you overcome?
- ✓ What are you passionate about? Why?
- ✓ How would your friends describe you as a person if they knew you were not listening?
- ✓ What is your strongest personal trait?
- ✓ What are the lessons you have learned?
- ✓ What values are important to you? Why?
- ✓ Did you ever have to make a difficult decision? Why was it so difficult? Are you happy with your choice?
- ✓ Do you look at problems/ issues differently than other people?
- ✓ Does someone look up to you? What have you done for them? How has this impacted you?
- ✓ What is your greatest accomplishment to date? What do you wish it could be?



PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE

Law schools will also consider an applicant's involvement on campus or in his/her community. Pre-law students are, therefore, strongly encouraged to volunteer, to participate in pre-law activities, and to complete internships. There are so many ways to get involved at YU. You can start by reading about the opportunities below and then be sure to follow up with the Pre-Law Career Advisor.

Internships

Practical legal experience is an excellent way of determining if a career in the law is right for you. Internship opportunities are available through the Yeshiva University Pre-Law Judicial Internship Program, at District Attorneys' offices, the Innocence Project, the American Civil Liberties Union, the Securities and Exchange Commission and many other governmental agencies and law firms. The Career Center should also be considered as a source for legal internships.

Langfan Family Constitutional Oratory Competition

The Langfan Constitutional Oratory Competition is an annual public speaking competition held each spring open to undergraduates on each campus regardless of major. The topic for the competition is generally a provocative and contemporary public issue which is conducive to public debate. Students are asked to deliver a five-minute presentation arguing for or against a resolution before a panel of three judges. After the presentations, each student receives individualized critiques from the judges. Cash prizes are awarded to the 1st, 2nd and 3rd place regardless of campus affiliation. If you are unsure about your interest in the law this competition is a great way to find out.

Yeshiva University's Jacob Hecht Pre-Law Society

YU has vibrant student-run Jacob Hecht Pre-Law Society on each campus. These student leaders work with the Pre-Law Career Advisor to organize visits with law school admissions officers, pre-law speakers, panelists and law-related field trips. Interested students should contact their advisor at their campus for more information.

The contacts for the Jacob Hecht Society are:

Wilf Campus: Daniel Melool - dmelool@mail.Yu.edu

Beren Campus: Eliana Wagner - Eliaanaw475@gmail.com

Yeshiva University Pre-Law Judicial Internship Program

This unpaid internship program provides Pre-Law students with the opportunity to observe and actively participate in the judicial process on a weekly basis during the academic year. Students will have the opportunity to work alongside our participating judges in courts throughout the New York State Unified Court System.



SELECTING A LAW SCHOOL

Deciding where to apply can be difficult as there are over 200 accredited law schools in the U.S. It is important to bear in mind that rankings are only one factor in selecting a law school. Keep in mind that the institution that best meets your needs may be very different from the best school for your classmates.

Some of the criteria that a student should consider in selecting a law school are:

Location

Do you have strong ties to a particular geographic location? Do you prefer city life to a more rural setting? Is there a specific geographic area where you would like to practice?

Size

Do you think you will have a better experience in a smaller class where the faculty-to-student ratio will likely be higher or do you welcome the advantages provided by a larger student body (i.e., more course offerings, a greater number of faculty members, and more students to interact with)?

Character of the Law School

Law schools are made up of people—students, professors, and administrators—therefore, each school has its own unique character. Some student bodies are more competitive, while others are more collegial and supportive. The best way to figure out the character of a law school is to speak with alumni who have or are attending the law school or to arrange for a visit to the school.

State/ Regional/ National Schools

Is the law school characterized as a national, state, or regional law school? Do students at the law school typically practice in the state, in the region, or do they have the mobility to practice in a variety of states across the nation? Students should look at the school's placement statistics, NALP, and <https://www.lawschooltransparency.com/> for the answers to these questions.

Faculty

Students should research the number and caliber of full-time faculty members. They should also look at the number of part-time faculty and the administrative staff of the law school. Faculty-to-student ratio, class sizes, and the approachability of faculty members are also important factors to consider.

Employment Rate/ Career Services

Does the school have a strong and supportive career services office? How successful has the school been in terms of placing students each year? What areas are these students working in, and in which geographic areas? What assistance is given to students who are not interested in working in law firms? This information can be obtained from NALP and/or from: <https://www.lawschooltransparency.com/>

Those students interested in working for a law firm should look into which firms participate in the school's On Campus Interview ("OCI") process and how deep into the class (i.e., top 10%, 20%, 50%...) each firm will go.



Journals

Does the school have journals in the areas you are interested in? How frequently are these journals cited in published opinions?

Joint Programs

Does the school offer a joint program in an area you are interested in?

Area of Interest

Do you have a specific area of interest? If so, look for schools that have a journal, a clinic and a full-time faculty member in that area. Some schools will claim to offer a specialty but in reality, only have 1-2 classes in that area.

Academia/Clerkships

Do you have a desire to go into academia or to clerk? Certain schools have much stronger placement rates for these positions.

Alumni Network

Does the law school have a strong alumni network committed to assisting future graduates?

Bar Passage Rate

How many students pass the bar on their first try each year?

Cost/ Scholarship Offers

What is the annual tuition per year? What are the additional living expenses for each school? If merit scholarships are not offered, what loan reimbursement plans are available?



HELPFUL WEBSITES

YU Pre-Law Advising Website: <https://www.yu.edu/academic-advising/pre-law>

The Law School Admissions Council: <http://www.lsac.org/>

NALP Pre-Law Portal: http://www.nalp.org/prelaw_portal

Law School Transparency: <http://www.lawschooltransparency.com/>

American Bar Association: <http://www.americanbar.org/aba.html>

National Jurist (Pre-Law): <http://www.nationaljurist.com/prelaw-home>

FinAid sponsored by the National Association of Student Financial Administrators: <http://www.finaid.org/>

LexisNexis: <http://www.lexisnexis.com/hottopics/lnacademic/> (accessible from YUcomputers)

Find Law: <http://www.findlaw.com/>

